CORE FALSE BELIEF #15 · THE WORLD & THE FUTURE

"The world is unsafe."

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Where it often comes from

This belief often comes from real danger: abuse, violence, a frightening accident, a crime, a natural disaster, or growing up in a chaotic home. Constant news of tragedy can strengthen it. After danger, the body stays on alert, scanning for threats. That alertness helped us survive, but when it never shuts off, it can keep us anxious, isolated, and unable to enjoy life.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that the world has dangers; Jesus said that in this world we will have trouble. But He added that He has overcome the world. The psalmist found shelter in the shadow of the Almighty and could lie down and sleep in peace because the Lord made him dwell in safety. The name of the Lord is a strong tower. God does not promise that nothing bad will ever happen, but He promises His presence, and our ultimate safety rests in Him.

> *"He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"* (Psalm 91:1–2).

Also see

> "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!" (John 16:33).

> "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety" (Psalm 4:8).

> "The name of the LORD is a strong tower; the righteous run to it and are safe" (Proverbs 18:10).

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You" (Isaiah 26:3).

Common self-statements

- Something bad could happen at any moment.
- I have to stay on guard.
- It's not safe to go out.
- People are dangerous.
- If I relax, I'll get hurt.
- Nowhere is safe.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Deciding that because danger happened once, it is everywhere.
- Catastrophizing: Treating unlikely dangers as certain.
- Mental filter: Focusing on threats and overlooking signs of safety.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing I am in danger because I feel afraid.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me the world is unsafe?

- Is that danger present now, or am I reacting to the past?
- What reasonable steps keep me safe, and which ones are excessive?
- Where have I been safe recently?
- What does God promise about His protection and presence?
- What could I enjoy if I felt a little safer?

Truth summary

> There are real dangers in the world, and I have been hurt before. But I am not in danger every moment. I can take sensible precautions and then rest, because God is my refuge. He has overcome the world, and I can find peace in Him.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Refuge/Safety
- Protection
- Fear
- Peace
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God's presence provides courage without requiring a life free of difficulty.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
Bring fear and uncertainty to God rather than carrying the outcome alone.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's power challenges the belief that evil or fear has the final authority.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "The world is unsafe"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The world is unsafe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me the world is unsafe?
- ☐ Is that danger present now?
- ☐ Which precautions are sensible and which are excessive?
- ☐ Where have I been safe recently?
- ☐ What does God promise about His protection?
- ☐ What could I enjoy if I felt safer?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my refuge and fortress.
- ☐ Jesus has overcome the world.
- ☐ I can lie down in peace.
- ☐ Feeling afraid is not the same as being in danger.
- ☐ I can take wise steps and then rest.
- ☐ The name of the Lord is a strong tower.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 91:1–2**
  "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"
- ☐ **John 16:33**
  "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"
- ☐ **Psalm 4:8**
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Where I was safe today: Each evening, write the places and moments you were safe today.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 91:1–2 becomes: "Karen can write: "The Lord is my refuge and my fortress. I can rest in His shelter today.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Refuge/Safety" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Separate past from present. Write what happened in the past that frightened you. Then write what is different about your situation now.
- ☐ Take one brave step. Choose one place or activity you avoid out of fear that is actually safe, and do it this week with support if needed.
- ☐ Limit the news. Choose a set time for news once a day instead of checking all day.
- ☐ Get help for trauma. If past danger still triggers strong fear, flashbacks, or nightmares, talk with a counselor trained to help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The world is unsafe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I felt safe
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The world is unsafe.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel unsafe so much of the time. Thank You that You are my refuge and that Jesus has overcome the world. Calm my body and mind, give me wisdom to stay safe, and help me rest in Your shelter. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.